VENZORAH

Launch readiness

What has been built, and what must be finished before the marketplace can take real orders from buyers and pay real sellers.

22 October 2026 · UK-first marketplace for African products

APPLICATION **Built in this project**	PUBLIC ADDRESS **venzorah.co.uk**
MONEY TODAY **Demonstration checkout only**	OPEN FOR TRADE **After the launch list below**

Where the project stands

Venzorah is one Next.js application. The shop, the customer account, the vendor dashboard, the admin desk and the database rules all live in this repository. There is no separate backend still to be written.

The site is deployed and the domain answers. A visitor can browse, create an account, and walk through checkout. That checkout does not charge a real card. Vendor earnings are calculated and stored, and an administrator can approve a withdrawal on the ledger. The money is not sent to a bank.

Safe to say today

- The product can be demonstrated to partners.
- Staff, buyers and vendors each have a working area.
- Prices, commission and shipping are calculated on the server in pence.
- The rules for a multi-vendor order are written and tested.

Hold the public launch

- No live card charge and no bank payout.
- The production database still has to be confirmed on Vercel.
- Email is recorded, and it is not delivered.
- Terms, privacy and returns are still placeholder text.

How to read the rest of this document

BUILT works in the application as described.

PARTIAL the screen or the rule exists, and a live service, a decision, or a production setting is still required.

REQUIRED do this before inviting the public to buy and sell.

LATER useful after the first public launch. It does not block the first real orders.

Stack used to build the app

One Next.js project holds the shop, the three dashboards and the server. Versions are those declared in the project on 22 October 2026.

LAYER	WHAT WE USE	WHAT IT DOES
Application	Next.js 16.4 App Router, React 19.3, TypeScript 5	Pages and server code in the same project. Dashboards call that server directly.
Interface	Tailwind CSS 4, Plus Jakarta Sans	Layout and brand colours in the global stylesheet. Light theme by default.
Database	PostgreSQL 16, Prisma ORM 6.19	Users, catalogue, orders, plans, payments and the seller ledger. Docker on a local machine.
Accounts	Session cookie, bcrypt, server-side roles	Email and password sign-in. Google, Facebook and Apple wait for their own keys.
Payments	Stripe SDK 23	Webhooks are ready. Checkout today is the in-app demonstration card form.
UK address	postcodes.io	Live postcode lookup, and search for a UK city or region.
Seller checks	Sylmera Identity	Verification screen. It runs when an API key is set.
Hosting	Vercel, venzorah.co.uk	Builds the app and, when configured, prepares the remote database. Installable as a PWA.
Checks	Vitest 5, ESLint 9, Zod 4	Tests for money, settlement, plans, sign-in routing and card expiry.

Supporting libraries. jose for signed tokens, date-fns for dates, nanoid for short ids, and next-themes for light and dark. Node 22 is the type target. There is no separate mobile app.

1. Shoppers

AREA	STATUS	WHAT A PERSON CAN DO
Home, categories, search	BUILT	Browse African food, fashion, beauty, home and the other catalogue groups. Categories use images. Products sit in rows on the home page.
Product and store	BUILT	Open a product, see its pictures, and follow the store name to that seller's other products.
Basket	BUILT	Add items without an account. After Add to cart, choose to continue shopping or go to checkout. The prompt closes when checkout starts.
Checkout gate	BUILT	A guest is asked to sign in or create an account, then returns to checkout to finish the order.
UK address	BUILT	Search a city or a UK region, and look up a real postcode. The city and region fill in from the address.
Account	BUILT	A profile for picture, name, mobile and email, separate from the orders dashboard. Wishlist, addresses, support and reviews are included.
Phone layout	BUILT	A bottom menu for Store, Search, Account, Wishlist and Menu. The site can be installed as an app from the browser.

2. Sellers

AREA	STATUS	WHAT A SELLER CAN DO
Dashboard	BUILT	A vendor who signs in through the seller entrance lands on the vendor dashboard. Their profile shows Dashboard in place of Sell on Venzorah.
Plans	PARTIAL	The first listing asks for an explicit plan, including Free. Upgrade and downgrade are available. A downgrade keeps the oldest live listings and moves the extras to draft. Staff can add and retire plans. Charging the plan fee is still outstanding.
Catalogue	BUILT	Products, pictures, inventory, a public store page, promotions and reviews.
Delivery rates	PARTIAL	Each seller sets their own methods and prices. Checkout uses those server prices. Live quotes from Royal Mail, Evri or DPD are not connected.
Verification	PARTIAL	The seller verification screen is ready for Sylmera Identity, including a UK company check. It stays idle until an API key is set.
Earnings	PARTIAL	The seller can see product proceeds, shipping kept, commission, money still in the waiting period, and money available. A withdrawal is a request. It is not a bank transfer.

3. Staff desk

Staff sign in at the admin entrance. Permissions are checked on the server, so hiding a button is not the only control.

People and catalogue

- Customers and vendors, including a vendor record.
- Products awaiting review, and categories.
- Support tickets and in-app notifications.
- Roles, permission overrides and an audit log.

Money and content

- Orders split by seller, with product, shipping, commission and the seller's amount.
- Plan editor, payout review, and a CSV of allocations.
- Disputes that hold only the seller involved.
- CMS pages, banners, reminders and platform settings.

4. How an order is divided

These rules are in the application and covered by tests. They apply when a payment is confirmed. They do not move money at a bank.

- **One checkout, one order per seller.** A basket with two sellers becomes a parent order and a sub-order for each seller.
- **Shipping stays with the seller who charged it.** The platform does not take a share of the delivery fee.
- **Commission is on goods only.** The seeded Free plan is 5% of eligible product sales, after any discount share. An active paid plan is 0% while it covers the sale. Seeded paid prices are £35 a month, £180 for six months and £336 a year. Staff can change plans.
- **Free plan listings.** The seeded Free plan allows 5 published listings. Paid plans are unlimited unless staff set a cap.
- **Seven-day wait.** Each sub-order becomes available after seven days, unless that seller has an open dispute. The wait is a setting, and a scheduled job has to run for the release to happen.
- **Refunds.** A product refund reverses the commission on that product amount. Shipping is refunded only when staff refund shipping on purpose. A dispute refund does not automatically refund the delivery fee.
- **The books balance.** Amounts are whole pence. A checkout that cannot be reconciled is refused. Paying the same order twice does not write a second payment.

> **Worked example, already in the tests.** Seller A sells £30 of goods and charges £5 delivery on the Free plan: commission £1.50, seller £33.50. Seller B sells £20 and charges £3.50 on a paid plan: commission £0, seller £23.50. The buyer pays £58.50. Venzorah's commission is £1.50. The £8.50 of delivery is not platform income.

5. Required before the public can trade

Do these in roughly this order. A public announcement before they are done would take orders the platform cannot collect or pay out.

	WORK	WHY IT BLOCKS LAUNCH
01	REQUIRED **Production database**	Set a remote PostgreSQL address on Vercel for Production and Preview, and include it in the build. Use the direct address, not a pooled host. A localhost address is ignored on purpose. Without this, new accounts and real orders on the live site have nowhere reliable to live. Then run one signup and one order on that database and confirm they are still there after a new deploy.
02	REQUIRED **Real card payments**	Checkout currently accepts the public test card 4242 4242 4242 4242 inside Venzorah's own form. No charge is made. Stripe keys are empty, and the Stripe webhook answers that it is not configured. Replace that form with Stripe Checkout or Stripe Elements so the card number never reaches Venzorah. Point the webhook at the live site and confirm a paid order only after Stripe says it is paid.
03	REQUIRED **Paid seller plans**	Choosing Monthly, 6-Month or Annual records the plan. It does not take the fee. A seller must be charged, through Stripe or another provider, before the 0% commission rate applies in production.
04	REQUIRED **How sellers get paid**	Withdrawals are requests on an internal ledger. Staff can approve them. There is no Stripe Connect account and no automatic transfer to a seller's bank. Choose the payout method, write it into the seller terms, and rehearse one payout from approval to money leaving Venzorah.
05	REQUIRED **The daily job**	Earnings leave the seven-day wait only when **POST /api/cron/jobs** runs. Subscriptions expire and reminders run in the same job. Nothing in the Vercel project calls it yet. Put it on a daily schedule and set a real **CRON_SECRET**. If that secret is left empty, the job does not check who is calling it.
06	REQUIRED **Email that arrives**	Password reset, order mail and seller notices are written to the database. They are not sent. Filling in an SMTP host still only marks the message as queued. Connect a real sender and receive one reset email, one order email and one seller email in a real inbox.

5. Required before the public can trade

	WORK	WHY IT BLOCKS LAUNCH
07	REQUIRED **Legal text and VAT**	Terms, privacy, returns, subscription terms and the contact page are short placeholders. The contact line still names a development address. A solicitor needs to review UK consumer rights, marketplace duties, seller contracts, subscriptions and refunds. Finance needs to decide VAT registration, whether delivery is taxed, and what appears on a receipt. The seven-day wait is an internal rule. It is escrow only if the payment provider and the contracts say so.
08	REQUIRED **Close the demonstration doors**	Demo passwords are in the project readme. A failed database lookup can still accept a demo session. The shop can fall back to a built-in catalogue. Turn that off on the public site, change every staff password, and keep the test card form off once Stripe is live.
09	REQUIRED **File storage**	Product photos are saved on the server's public disk. Identity documents are saved on a private folder on the same machine. Vercel does not keep that disk between deployments. Move public images to object storage and identity files to a private bucket before sellers upload real documents.
10	REQUIRED **One dress rehearsal**	On the production database, with test mode still on at the payment provider: a new buyer pays, the seller sees only their sub-order, the daily job releases the earning after the wait, staff approve a payout, and a refund reverses commission without refunding delivery by accident. Launch after that rehearsal passes.

6. Finish these for a convincing public opening

AREA	STATUS	WHAT IS LEFT
Seller identity checks	PARTIAL	Add Sylmera keys, or another provider, and complete one individual check and one UK company check.
Real catalogue	PARTIAL	Replace demonstration goods with sellers, prices and photographs you are willing to sell.
Support and social	PARTIAL	Use a real support address. Point Facebook, X and Instagram at Venzorah’s own profiles. The country names in the footer open the general product list.
App store badges	LATER	The App Store and Google Play badges open the install page for the website. There is no native app yet. iPhone users add the site from the Share menu.
Social sign-in	LATER	Google, Facebook and Apple can be switched on with their own app credentials. Email and password already work.
Carriers and push	LATER	Label printing, live carrier prices and browser push can follow the first launch. In-app notices already exist.
Care of the system	REQUIRED	Turn on database backups and prove a restore. Watch errors on Vercel. Limit repeated sign-in attempts. Keep secrets out of the repository.

7. A practical order of work

1. **Database and secrets.** Remote Postgres, a new staff password, a cron secret, and the public site address.
2. **Stripe for buyers.** Live or test keys, hosted card entry, and a webhook that marks the order paid.
3. **Stripe for seller plans.** The fee is collected before the 0% commission applies.
4. **Payout decision.** Bank transfer by staff, or a connected-account product. Say which one in the seller agreement.
5. **Email.** A sender that delivers, tested with a real inbox.
6. **Daily job.** Earnings, expired plans and reminders run every day.
7. **Storage.** Photos and identity documents survive a new deploy and stay private where they must.
8. **Legal and VAT.** Replace the placeholder pages and confirm the receipt.
9. **Identity checks and the first real sellers.**
10. **Switch off demonstration sign-in, the test card and the fallback catalogue.**
11. **Dress rehearsal, then open.**

8. What “launched” should mean

Ready to demonstrate

This is the project today. Partners can click through the shop, the three dashboards and a demonstration payment on venzorah.co.uk, once the database is attached. Say that it is a demonstration.

Ready to trade

A stranger can pay, a seller is checked, the fee and the commission match the contract, the earning is released by the daily job, and the seller can be paid. Items 01 to 10 in section 5 are the gate.

> **What this document is.** It describes the application as it stands on 22 October 2026. It is a delivery and launch list. It is not a legal opinion, a VAT opinion, or a payment-provider contract. Prices of plans can be changed by staff. The commission and shipping rules above are the rules in the code.